

Assignment 08: Shaders and Beta Release

Feedback from Alpha Release

Below is a summary of the changes our testers suggested or changes we decided to make based on the observations made during testing. The green points are the ones we implemented for the beta release, orange indicates what we are in the process of implementing, and red represents the feedback that we rejected either due to time constraints or because we didn't think it would align well with our game concept.

1. We should explain the objective and game resources in the instructions section of the splash screen
2. Make sure the background music loops
3. We should make it clearer what the clothing store is for and how it helps the player
 - a. We should explain that the player will be hidden from the paparazzi for 10 seconds in the UI when they are choosing their outfit
 - b. Also, have a separate timer for them to know when their disguise will be revealed
4. Remove barriers at the audition center
5. The arrow is pointing towards the gate, not the audition center building
6. One tester suggested we have a map of our game
7. The arrow should lead you to all centers. It disappears after 3 right now
8. Perhaps add more traffic, and ragdoll animation when you get hit
9. Audition center buildings should be different colors
 - a. Actually, tell them they completed the audition once they are done, so it's more obvious
10. Money should be earned and spent when you complete an audition, use a taxi, or buy a dress, but needs to be merged with/ other scripts
11. The sunrise and sunset should match the time more closely and shouldn't loop. Perhaps add an end screen
12. Fix the clunkiness of the player's movements. The player doesn't jump super high right now, and also, there is a delay when you transition from walking to running
13. Perhaps make one of the coffee shops a power-up to move faster in the game
14. We should add more paparazzi. The player doesn't really interact with them as much right now.
15. We should add more fans. The player doesn't really interact with them as much right now.
16. See if you can make the fans spin around you once you have entered the box collider.

Beta Release

1. Change: Game objective added to splash screen
 - a. Why? It was implemented so that the users know how to play the game. During alpha testing, we noticed that the players were often confused about what to do

and where to go. They, of course, would figure it out 5-10 minutes into the game, but we felt like it would be better to equip this information earlier on so they know how to play the game.

2. Change: Make sure the background music loops
 - a. Why? A game needs to always have background music playing in the background, or it will sound awkward.
3. Change: We added instructions on how to buy the disguise and what the disguise is for, and how to use it.
 - a. Why? We added it because a lot of players assumed that changing their outfit had to do with how popular they became in the game, so we wanted to make it clear.
4. Change: We changed the arrow that guides the user to point towards the actual audition buildings instead of the gate.
 - a. Why? This is because once the user reaches the gate, the arrow would automatically point towards the next audition center. They wouldn't think to go inside the audition center because of this. We also fixed the issue of the arrow disappearing after visiting 3 audition centers.
5. Change: We added more street traffic.
 - a. Why? We added more street traffic because the players felt that the game wasn't challenging enough.
6. Change: We added a feature that makes the character glow after they have completed the audition center.
 - a. Why? Initially, when the user completed their audition center, the score on the game screen that shows how many auditions have been completed would be updated, but the player wouldn't notice because they were so focused on taking the character to the next audition center. As a result, they didn't realize the purpose of entering the audition center. Hence, we added this visual glow to the character itself.
7. Change: We made a change so that the sunrise and sunset should match the time countdown. We fixed a bug and made sure the time doesn't loop, and the game ends after the time is up.
 - a. Why? During alpha testing, the sunrise and sunset didn't match the time countdown. As a result, the player didn't know the sunsetting was a visual indicator to help them understand that time is running out in the game.
8. Change: We added more paparazzi and fans to the game
 - a. Why? To make the game more challenging
9. Form of writing 1: We have added an instructions screen to our splash screen to introduce the user to the game, how it is played, and what controls they need to get around the game.
10. Form of writing 2: We have added instructions that explain purchasing and changing their outfit, which will allow them to temporarily hide from the fans and paparazzi. The text has been added to the UI screen that appears when the user enters the clothing store.

11. Form of writing 3: We have added a credits screen that will be displayed at the end of the game. This includes all our names, that this was work done at UIC as part of CS426 Videogame Design, and credit for all art (including sounds) we used.
12. Shader Construct 1: We added a shader construct that makes the player glow and flash when they complete an audition to give them visual feedback.
13. Shader Construct 2: We added a shader construct to the paparazzi bar that turns red when the user has stayed in the perimeter of the paparazzi for too long, and the paparazzi is about to click the picture.
14. Shader Construct 3: We added green/red shader constructs to the taxi windows in the game, so the user know which taxis are entry/exit points.